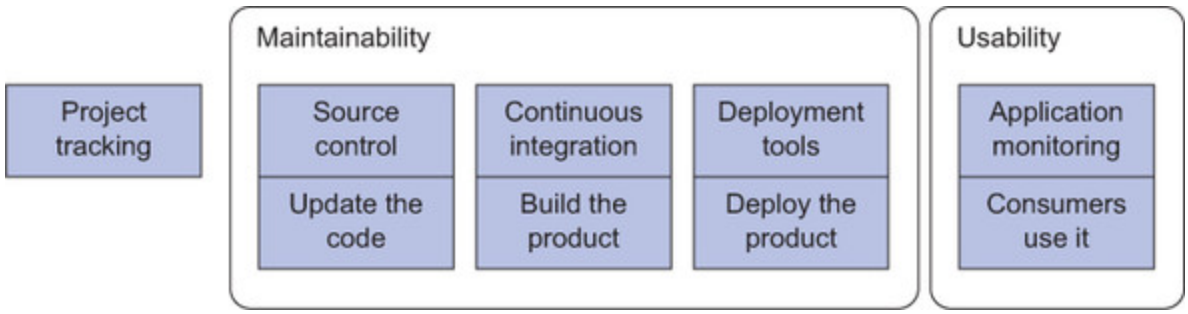
Maintainability encompasses getting changes out to the consumer and all the pieces of the build lifecycle that contribute to that.

Usability tells you if the consumer gets what they need out of the system with the least amount of friction possible. Wrapped up in that is whether the consumer has a secure, reliable experience that can scale to meet demand.

If you wrap extensibility with maintainability and you group security, scalability, and reliability under usability, you can redraw figure 8.2 as figure 8.3.

Figure 8.3. Grouping systems used in the development lifecycle together by the two parent code "ilities"



With these in mind we'll focus on the two biggest code "ilities" as we look into how to measure good software:

- Maintainability to represent how easily you can get changes out to the consumer
- Usability to represent customer satisfaction

Maintainability and extensibility

In the context of agile delivery, the ability to easily change and deploy your code is paramount. Often maintainability and extensibility are treated as separate entities. Maintainability refers to the effort needed to keep your software alive and running. Extensibility refers to the level of effort required to add new features or extend an application. In today's agile world where continuous methods are becoming more common, there's no longer a